

Wednesday, 19 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light rain

24° 16°

BIRMINGHAM

Drizzle

22° 15°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

20° 14°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

16° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **Heart-breaking news from Greece, where a British honeymoon couple have been tragically killed in a helicopter crash.**

Alexander Cromie and Marie Ebert, who had just got married, died alongside their Greek pilot. The accident happened on a Greek island, and investigations are now underway.

TRAGEDY · UK

- 2 **The Prime Minister has reaffirmed the UK's unwavering support for Ukraine, after Russia issued a warning about British-made drones.**

Russia has accused the UK of escalating the conflict by supplying drones to Kyiv. However, the Prime Minister vowed to stand by Ukraine in its 'hour of need'.

POLITICS · UK

- 3 **Concerns have been raised that some British parents may have been misled about sperm and egg donors at IVF clinics in northern Cyprus.**

It's feared that multiple children may have been conceived using different donors than those specifically chosen by the parents. This has sparked a great deal of worry for families involved.

HEALTH · UK

- 4 **One person has died and hundreds more have been taken ill in a salmonella outbreak across the UK.**

Most of the cases have been reported in England over recent weeks. Experts believe the outbreak is linked to eating imported eggs, and investigations are ongoing.

HEALTH · UK

- 5 **Good news for anyone who's ever been annoyed by someone else's phone in a pub, as Wetherspoons has now banned customers from playing music from their devices.**

The popular pub chain says the decision follows numerous complaints. It covers both playing music and amplified phone conversations, aiming for a more peaceful atmosphere.

SOCIAL · UK

What's coming up

1 **The National Television Awards have made history by revealing their first ever all-female shortlist for the drama acting award.**

The five talented actresses up for the prestigious award are Ella Bruccoleri, Sheridan Smith, Ruth Jones, Vicky McClure, and Judy Parfitt. It's a fantastic recognition of their work.

ON AIR – Who do you think deserves to win this year's drama acting NTA?

AWARDS · COMING SOON

2 **Kanye West has announced a series of tour dates in Russia, which would make him the first major Western artist to play there since the invasion of Ukraine.**

This news is certainly making waves in the music world. It will be interesting to see the reaction to his decision to perform in the country.

ON AIR – What do you make of Kanye West's decision to tour in Russia?

MUSIC · COMING SOON

3 **There are some noise concerns being raised over Reading Festival's plans to extend its music hours this year.**

Charli XCX, rapper Dave, and Chase & Status are set to headline the festival later this month. Residents are keen to make sure the extended hours don't cause too much disruption.

ON AIR – If you live near a festival, how much noise is too much noise?

MUSIC · COMING SOON

4 **The film commission has given its backing to Amazon MGM's plans for a major expansion of its studios in Berkshire.**

The Berkshire film studio was once the home of the iconic horror studio Hammer Films. This expansion promises more jobs and a boost for the UK film industry.

ON AIR – Is it good news to see more big film studios setting up shop in the UK?

FILM · COMING SOON

5 **Gillian Anderson recently shared her feelings of 'betrayal' regarding allegations surrounding 'The Salt Path', a film she appeared in.**

The film, an adaptation of the best-selling book, is set to be released in the United States by Rialto Distribution in September. It's a story that has clearly resonated with many.

ON AIR – Have you ever felt betrayed by something you were passionate about?

FILM · COMING SOON

On the schedule

- 1 **Sheffield United are facing a High Court hearing today, with their owners facing a winding-up order.**
This could have significant consequences for the Championship club, including a potential 12-point deduction. Fans will be anxiously awaiting the outcome of the hearing.

ON AIR – How much do off-field issues affect your enjoyment of your favourite club?
FOOTBALL · UK

- 2 **A consortium that includes Amazon founder Jeff Bezos has reportedly bought almost 40% of Liverpool Football Club.**
The purchase was made from Fenway Sports Group, who own the club. This significant investment could mean big changes for the Reds.

ON AIR – What impact do you think new big-name investors have on a football club?
FOOTBALL · UK

- 3 **Newcastle United have completed a significant £30 million move for Benfica defender Amar Dedic.**
The signing sees the talented defender join the Premier League club. It's a big investment and fans will be hoping he makes a strong impact.

ON AIR – Which new Premier League signing are you most excited to see in action this season?
FOOTBALL · UK

- 4 **England's new Test captain, Joe Root, has called on his players to be 'good human beings' as he begins his second reign.**
Root emphasised the importance of being 'really good role models' both on and off the pitch. It's a clear message as they look ahead to their upcoming matches.

ON AIR – How important is it for sports stars to be good role models?
CRICKET · UK

- 5 **British F1 driver Alex Albon has committed his future to Williams, signing a new contract extension that will keep him with the team until the end of the 2027 season.**
This is great news for Williams and for British motorsport fans. Albon has been a key part of the team's recent progress, and this new deal secures his place for years to come.

ON AIR – What does Alex Albon's new contract mean for Williams' chances in F1?
FORMULA 1 · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees city dwellers 'adopting' a small patch of public green space to care for.**
Residents are tidying, planting, and nurturing neglected corners, transforming them into mini urban oases for everyone to enjoy. It's a lovely way to foster community spirit.
- 2 Research suggests that 'writing a handwritten letter' can significantly reduce stress and improve mental well-being.**
The act of slow, deliberate communication, without the immediacy of digital platforms, offers a calming pause in our busy lives. Plus, receiving one is always a treat!
- 3 The simple joy of 'building a den' is experiencing a heartwarming resurgence among families.**
Whether it's indoors with blankets and cushions or outdoors with branches and leaves, families are rediscovering the imaginative fun of creating a cosy hideaway together.
- 4 A study found that 'listening to the rain' can have a profoundly calming effect on the human mind.**
The gentle, rhythmic sound of raindrops is thought to trigger a primal sense of safety and relaxation, making it a natural stress-reliever. Perfect for a quiet afternoon.
- 5 The delightful pastime of 'collecting interesting pebbles' from beaches and riverbanks is becoming a popular hobby.**
People are finding beauty in the natural world, curating their unique collections based on shape, colour, and texture. Some even paint them!
- 6 New findings indicate that 'gazing at the stars' can inspire feelings of wonder and perspective.**
Taking a moment to look up at the night sky helps to put everyday worries into context and reminds us of the vastness and beauty of the universe. Grab a cuppa and look up!
- 7 The charming tradition of 'leaving out books for others to find' in public spaces is growing.**
Often accompanied by a small note, these 'book fairies' aim to spread the joy of reading and foster a sense of shared discovery in communities.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out if our tea is cool enough to drink without burning our tongue?

ANSWER: ANSWER: ...TAKING A TINY, ALMOST IMPERCEPTIBLE SIP FROM THE VERY EDGE OF THE CUP, JUST TO TEST THE WATERS!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh piece of fruit. What is it?

ANSWER: ANSWER: ...TAPPING IT GENTLY TO CHECK FOR RIPENESS, EVEN IF THEY HAVE NO IDEA WHAT THE 'RIGHT' TAP SOUNDS LIKE!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you hear a 'word or phrase' that just sounds utterly charming, or a bit old-fashioned, and it makes you smile?**

We all have those lovely turns of phrase, maybe from a grandparent or a favourite book, that we wish people still used more often. What's your favourite quaint word or saying that needs a comeback?

- **We all have those 'little rituals' that mark the start of a new season, don't we?**

As we move further into autumn, perhaps it's bringing out a favourite jumper, or making that first hearty soup of the year. What's your tell-tale sign that a new season has truly begun?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** The Earth's oceans contain enough salt to cover all the landmasses in the world with a layer approximately 150 metres deep.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts on the International Space Station can only drink recycled water that has been filtered from their own sweat and tears, making every drop precious.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The 'Unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- Bubble wrap was originally intended to be used as wallpaper.
- Strawberries are the only fruit with seeds on the outside.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds.
- Fingernails grow faster than toenails.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.
- The small plastic tip on the end of a shoelace is called an 'aglet'.

On this day

Day 231 of the year, 134 days left in 2026. Today Afghan Independence Day, commemorates the Treaty of Rawalpindi in 1919, granting independence from Britain (Afghanistan); August Revolution Commemoration Day (Vietnam); Birthday of Crown Princess Mette-Marit (Norway); Christian Feast Day: Bertulf of Bobbio. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — Romeo Miller, American basketball player, rapper, actor
- 1980 — Darius Campbell, Scottish singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actor (died 2022)
- 1984 — Ryan Taylor, English footballer
- 1946 — Dawn Steel, American film producer (died 1997)
- 1952 — Jonathan Frakes, American actor and director
- 1975 — Tracie Thoms, American actress
- 1951 — John Deacon, English bass player and songwriter
- 1969 — Nate Dogg, American rapper (died 2011)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1981 — Gulf of Sidra Incident: United States F-14A Tomcat fighters intercept and shoot down two Libyan Sukhoi Su-22 fighter jets over the Gulf of Sidra.
- 2009 — A series of bombings in Baghdad, Iraq, kills 101 and injures 565 others.
- 2010 — Operation Iraqi Freedom ends, with the last of the United States brigade combat teams crossing the border to Kuwait.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1953 — Cold War: The CIA and MI6 help to overthrow the government of Mohammad Mosaddegh in Iran and reinstate the Shah Mohammad Reza Pahlavi.
- 1955 — In the Northeast United States, severe flooding caused by Hurricane Diane, claims 200 lives.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2010 — Operation Iraqi Freedom ends, with the last of the United States brigade combat teams crossing the border to Kuwait.
- 2017 — Tens of thousands of farmed non-native Atlantic salmon are accidentally released into the wild in Washington waters in the 2017 Cypress Island Atlantic salmon pen break.

- 1999 — In Belgrade, Yugoslavia, tens of thousands of Serbians rally to demand the resignation of Federal Republic of Yugoslavia President Slobodan Milošević.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 232 of the year, 133 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Amadour; Christian feast day: Bernard of Clairvaux; Christian feast day: Blessed Georg Häfner; Christian feast day: Heliodorus of Bet Zabdai. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1971 — David Walliams, English comedian, actor, and author
- 1948 — Robert Plant, English singer-songwriter
- 1934 — Tom Mangold, German-English journalist and author
- 1949 — Phil Lynott, Irish singer-songwriter, bass player, and producer (died 1986)
- 1992 — Alex Newell, American actor and singer
- 1981 — Ben Barnes, English actor
- 1992 — Demi Lovato, American singer-songwriter and actress
- 1971 — Ke Huy Quan, Vietnamese-American actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1975 — Viking program: NASA launches the Viking 1 planetary probe toward Mars.
- 1975 — ČSA Flight 540 crashes on approach to Damascus International Airport in Damascus, Syria, killing 126 people.
- 2007 — China Airlines Flight 120 catches fire and explodes after landing at Naha Airport in Okinawa, Japan.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1905 — Sun Yat-sen, Song Jiaoren, and others establish the Tongmenghui, a Republican, anti-Qing revolutionary organisation, in Tokyo, Japan.
- 1977 — Voyager program: NASA launches the Voyager 2 spacecraft.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

22–23

Belgian Grand Prix (F1)